MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS

Approved 6/18/25

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

Unapproved minutes
May 21, 2025

Meeting was called to order at 9:01 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Dale Majewski, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis, District 8 George Gilmore and District 9 Rick Fancon

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

None

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, members of the public and zoom participants

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to amend the agenda to include the additions as listed, **Motion carried.**

IV. Approval of Minutes
Special Meeting Minutes of April 14, 2025

VI. Communications List
Kyle Lewis, Airports and State Advocacy Regional Manager

VIII. Special Presentations
Presentation by Michigan Department of Transportation (MDOT) Bureau of Aeronautics

IX. Justice
Revision to appointment list

XI. Physical Resources and Economic Development
Fiscal-Year (FY) 2025 MDOT State Local Program Funding Awards of $250,000 for Upgrading Airfield Lighting on Runway 18/36 at the Clare County Airport and $4,806 for Sealing Pavement Surface/Pavement Joints at the Clare County Airport

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to accept the agenda as amended, **Motion carried.**

APPROVAL OF MINUTES

It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve the Special Meeting Minutes of April 14, 2025 and the Board of Commissioners Meeting Minutes of April 16, 2025, **Motion carried**.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public asked that the Commissioners accept the grants for the Clare County Airport later in their discussion.

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT - continued

A long-time resident expressed her preference for keeping the Clare County Airport open. She added that the Fly-In event was great despite the weather.

A non-Clare County resident who drove 174 miles to show his support for the airport appealed to the Commissioners to continue to fund the airport. As a pilot of ten years, he has flown into the Clare County Airport in the past and plans to continue to fly in and to support the local businesses and restaurants.

A Clare County resident shared a few observations regarding the airport. She hopes that if the County considers keeping the airport they would consider building additional usable structures. If not, then she hopes they would evaluate rent increases. She asked the Board of Commissioners to review the application and grant agreement before making a decision.

ADMINISTRATOR'S REPORT

Administrator Lori Phelps informed the Commissioners that the post audit reports are completed and filed with the State and Federal Government. The final American Rescue Plan Act (ARPA) report is complete as well. The FY 2026 budget will be ready for review at the June Board Meeting. The County should be 66.7% expensed for FY2025 and is currently 51.47% expensed.

COMMUNICATIONS LIST

1. Notification of Neighborhood Enterprise Zone establishment from the City of Harrison – No discussion

2. Notification of Residential Housing Exemption Certificate (RHEC) District establishment from the City of Harrison – No discussion

3. Mobile Medical Response (MMR) Annual Report – No discussion

4. Medical Examiner's Report – No discussion

5. Letter of support from the Clare Area Pilots Association – No discussion

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS

1. Office of Aeronautics, Michigan Department of Transportation
   Hilary Hoose presented the Board of Commissioners with an Economic Benefit Assessment for the Clare County Airport. The Clare County Airport has a direct local output of over $967,000.00 and a statewide output impact of over $1 million. Additionally, a total of over $2.2 million of state economic impact is created by the airport. Hilary Hoose stated that the airport proves to be a worthwhile economic generator.

   A few businesses have expressed interest in coming to the Clare County Airport including a business that builds race engines and a military helicopter salvage business. She concluded her presentation by saying that our community is fortunate to have an airport and losing the airport would more than likely result in another airport not being able to be licensed.

2. Community Mental Health for Central Michigan
   Bryan Krogman approached the Board of Commissioners to discuss a resolution that would serve to oppose a current effort by the Michigan Department of Health and Human Services to initiate a procurement effort of the State's prepaid in-patient health plans. They are seeking to oppose this effort or if there is a procurement that does proceed then the entities should have experience managing Michigan's public health system.

PUBLIC HEARINGS/SPECIAL PRESENTATIONS - continued

2. Community Mental Health for Central Michigan - continued
   Privatization could disrupt the relationship between local mental health authorities, providers and the communities they serve. The public system treats individuals first, there is no profit motive.

   It was moved by Commissioner Gilmore, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve Resolution #25-11 Opposing Privatization of Mental Health Services Programs, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Fancon, Gross, Hoefling, Gilmore, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Housler, Kleinhardt and Haskell
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

3. Clare/Gladwin Community Corrections Grant
   Charlie Pistro, Director of the Department of Corrections, Honorable Judge Ambrozaitis – 55th Circuit Court and Honorable Judge Hovey – 55th Circuit Court explained the need for the Board's support for the Clare/Gladwin Community Corrections program that they would like to establish. The program has to provide appropriate sanctions and services with the goal of reducing occurrence of repeat criminal offenses that result in incarceration.

   Judge Ambrozaitis shared that they are focusing on a small part of the Community Corrections program – a pre-trial services program. This will not compete with the Recovery Court, it will compliment it. The State funds the entire program so no money comes out of the County budget. The Gladwin County Board of Commissioners has already approved for them to proceed with the application process. Judge Hovey added that this grant has been available since 1988 and this is the first time Clare/Gladwin Counties have applied.

JUSTICE

1. Circuit Court
   a. It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Housler to approve Resolution #25-10 in support of the Clare and Gladwin Community Corrections to apply for the FY 2026 Community Corrections grant as presented, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Gross, Housler, Kleinhardt, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Gilmore, Fancon and Hoefling
      Nays: (0)
      Absent: (0)
      Motion carried.

   b. It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the appointments as presented to a one (1) year term to the Regional Advisory Board which fulfills the requirements of PA 511 of 1988, **Motion carried.**

JUSTICE – continued

1. Circuit Court - continued

    c. It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to appoint Commissioner Jeff Haskell to serve as the County Commissioner Primary Designee and Commissioner Jacob Gross as the County Commissioner Alternate to the Community Corrections Regional Advisory Board, **Motion carried.**

2. Recovery Court/OPIOID
   Chief Judge Josh Farrell explained to the Board of Commissioners the need to expand the Recovery Court to include a Recovery Services Coordinator position. He shared that they recently discovered a need to fill some gaps in the community. The goal is to provide the assistance needed to the individuals that are not in the criminal justice system. This position will serve both Clare and Gladwin Counties.

   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve the expansion of the Recovery Court Program to better address the increasing needs of individuals with Opioid Use Disorder and co-occurring Substance Use Disorders. This expansion will include the development of pre-trial services that connect individuals to evidence-based treatment, supportive services and diversion or deflection strategies prior to arrest or arraignment. Funding for these efforts will be allocated from the Opioid Settlement Funds, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Housler, Haskell, Majewski, Kleinhardt, Hoefling and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

Recess: 10:22 a.m.
Back in session: 10:31 a.m.

3. Medical Examiner
   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the use of Opioid funds to equip the Clare County Medical Examiner's Office with portable tablet devices for on-scene use in the amount of $8,250.00 with an annual subscription of $2,000.00 for the next five years, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewksi, Kleinhardt, Housler, Hoefling, Haskell, Gross, Gilmore, Fancon and Ambrozaitis
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

4. Jury Board
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Gross to appoint Larry Gawel for a partial term ending April 30, 2027 and re-appoint Linda Barkell to the Jury Board for a six year term ending May 31, 2031, **Motion carried.**

JUSTICE - continued

5. 911 Dispatch
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve Resolution #25-12 to levy increased monthly telephone surcharge for Emergency Telephone Services as approved by Board vote in 2020, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Hoefling, Gross, Ambrozaitis, Haskell, Majewski, Housler, Kleinhardt, Fancon and Gilmore
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Haskell to accept the FY 2025 MDOT State Local Program Funding Award of $250,000 for Upgrading Airfield Lighting on Runway 18/36 at the Clare County Airport, without any matching County funds and to accept the FY 2025 MDOT State Local Program Funding Award of $4,806 for Sealing Pavement Surface/Pavement Joints at the Clare County Airport, without any matching County funds, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (7) being Commissioners Gross, Hoefling, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Kleinhardt and Haskell
   Nays: (2) being Commissioners Gilmore and Housler
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Statutory Finance Committee
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to approve Statutory Finance Committee meeting minutes of April 14, 2025 in the amount of $108,674.38, the meeting minutes of April 28, 2025 in the amount of $230,094.20 and the meeting minutes of May 12, 2025 in the amount of $102,575.33, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Hoefling, Majewski, Gross, Ambrozaitis, Haskell, Housler, Kleinhardt and Fancon
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

2. Monthly Expenditures
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the expenditures for the month of April 2025, in the amount of $7,766,292.00 with the General Fund expenditures totaling $1,218,757.90, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Haskell, Ambrozaitis, Majewski, Fancon, Kleinhardt, Housler, Gilmore, Hoefling and Gross
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

3. Budget Adjustments
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Fancon to approve Budget Adjustment #25-92 in the amount of $12,917,398.35 and Budget Adjustment #25-99 in the amount of $121,590.75, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

4. Friend of the Court Appropriation
   It was moved by Commissioner Fancon, seconded by Commissioner Housler to appropriate $75,000 from the General Fund to the Friend of the Court Fund, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Majewski, Kleinhardt, Housler, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Ambrozaitis, Fancon and Gilmore
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

5. Personnel
   It was moved by Commissioner Kleinhardt, seconded by Commissioner Housler to renew the County Administrator's contract through December 2028, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Gilmore, Haskell, Housler, Majewski, Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gross, Hoefling and Kleinhardt
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

6. Software Purchase
   Administrator Lori Phelps put in a request to purchase ClearGov software to aid in her audits, this will save the County approximately $10,000 in comparison to what is currently being utilized.

   It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Majewski to allow the Administrator to purchase ClearGov software at $10,080.00 with a $10,800.00 annual subscription fee each year through September 2028, roll call vote revealed:

   Yeas: (9) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Fancon, Gilmore, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler, Kleinhardt and Majewski
   Nays: (0)
   Absent: (0)
   Motion carried.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT

Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott gave an update regarding the recent May 6, 2025 Election. There were no issues and there was a higher than expected voter turnout. This was directly related to the permanent ballot mailing list. Both millages on the ballots passed. The Circuit Court staff sent out over 6,000 jury qualification questionnaires and are working hard to input them into the system. The Jury Board met for the initial round and will meet again in July to go over the remaining questionnaires.

CLERK/REGISTER OF DEEDS REPORT - continued

The two vacant Circuit Court employee positions in the Clerk's Office will soon be filled. Veterans at the Veteran's Coffee Hour continue to sign up for Property Fraud Alerts, along with members of the jury during a recent jury trial. Clerk and Register of Deeds Lori Mott also thanked the Board of Commissioners for supporting the Recovery Court. She has a family member that is sober for the past five years because of the Recovery Court. He currently mentors participants in the program and his family is very proud of him. Lastly, she expressed pride in a member of her staff, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter, who will be the keynote speaker at the Memorial Day Ceremony this year.

TREASURER'S REPORT

Treasurer Jenny Beemer-Fritzinger provided all the statutory reports to the Commissioners – the current cash on hand, investments, and fund balances as of May 20, 2025, as well as the cash summary by funds for the month of April. She included a revenue trend report from 2009 – Projected FY 2025 and clarified that all figures on this report are actual except in the last column, which is the projected budget as of May 20, 2025. She also included a fund balance trend graph and explained that the 2020 COVID shut down and ARPA funding in 2021 helped reset the county finances. They have reached and exceeded the goal of 35% for the fund balance as a percent of expenses due to the COVID shut down, ARPA funding and the efficiencies the new Administrator has put into place.

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger mentioned that the 2024 tax settlement checks were sent out at the end of April and all millage entities (Transit, 911, Senior Services, schools, libraries, local units, county, etc.) should be able to operate for the rest of the year. She is working with the local unit treasurers to begin collecting the 2025 taxes. Her office creates databases to match the local unit to prepare for the tax season.

Treasurer Beemer-Fritzinger announced a save the date – the first public tax reverted land auction will be Friday, August 22, 2025. The auction will be online only and as of now, 51 properties will be going to sale. Lastly, her office is working with the clerk's office to move toward e-tax certifications.

CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Chairman George Gilmore congratulated Commissioner Ambrozaitis and the Fly-In crew. He has been attending his meetings and had nothing to report.

VICE CHAIRMAN'S REPORT

Vice Chairman Rick Fancon had nothing to report.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT

Commissioner Hoefling expressed his gratitude for the Board's support for the Clare County Airport. He has attended his meetings and gave a report on each of the townships and committees he represents.

Commissioner Ambrozaitis publicly thanked those involved in the Fly-In. Many local businesses and members of the public provided services and support.

Commissioner Housler has attended her meetings and had nothing to report. She congratulated the Road Commission on the ground breaking of their new building.

Commissioner Kleinhardt expressed concern regarding the uncertainty of the Federal and State budgets.

COMMISSIONER'S REPORT - continued

Commissioner Haskell had nothing to report.

Commissioner Gross gave an update on his townships.

Commissioner Majewski reported on attending his meetings.

PUBLIC COMMENT

A member of the public complimented the Board on the new sound system. He is auditory challenged so he appreciates now being able to hear while sitting in the gallery.

A Harrison resident commented that she has researched ClearGov software and she wanted to point out that it is a great software to have for transparency for the constituents.

A third member expressed his appreciation for the Board's support for the Clare County Airport. He also thanked the Commissioners for approving the expansion of the Recovery Court.

Another member of the public thanked the Commissioners who voted to accept the grants for the Clare County Airport. The Airport has a wonderful opportunity to benefit the whole community.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

It was moved by Commissioner Majewski, seconded by Commissioner Gross to adjourn the meeting at 11:37 a.m., **Motion carried**.

Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners